New starts in Christianity and Judaism reading cards

White standard print

Two different festivals

People can think about new starts in different ways. We will compare two festivals. Easter belongs to Christianity. Rosh Hashanah is the Jewish New Year festival in Judaism. The festivals have different stories and meanings. They happen at different times of year. They are not the same festival. Christians believe that Jesus rose from death. Easter celebrates this. For Christians it brings hope and new life. Many Christians use eggs as signs of new life. A chick can hatch from an egg. Christians may celebrate in different ways. The egg is one sign. The story of Jesus is at the heart of the festival.

Rosh Hashanah in Judaism

Rosh Hashanah is the start of the Jewish new year. Many Jewish people think about how they have acted and how they can do better. Many eat apple dipped in honey. The sweet taste shows a hope for a good, sweet year. Jewish families may have different customs. We will learn about the food. No one has to eat it or say a prayer.

A link and a difference

Both festivals can link with hope. One difference is what each festival marks. Easter celebrates Jesus rising from death. Rosh Hashanah marks the Jewish new year. People with no religious belief may also make a new start. We can find a link while keeping the beliefs clear.

Learn about these ideas without sharing your own belief. An adult can reread a short part.

Cards to discuss

A

Christianity: Easter celebrates Jesus rising from death.

B

Judaism: Rosh Hashanah marks the Jewish new year.

C

Many Christians use an egg as a sign of new life.

D

Many Jewish people eat apple and honey to show hope for a sweet year.

E

The festival can link with hope.

F

The festivals happen at different times of year.